

Key Equivalents

In most programs, the most frequently used menu items are also available through keys on the keyboard. Look for menu items with the ⌘ symbol next to them, like Eject in Figure 5A. Holding down the ⌘ key while pressing the letter E is the same as selecting “Eject” from the Disk menu. As you become more familiar with the operation of the programs you use the most, you’ll find yourself reaching for the key equivalents more and more—they really are time-savers, especially in programs like word processors where it can be a hassle to continually move your hand from the keyboard to the mouse and back.

➡ Shortcut

The following key equivalents are supported by many (but not all) Desktop programs. The first four Edit menu key equivalents are the first four keys at the left of the bottom row of letters—Apple chose them because they weren’t as likely to be needed by programs for other functions.

File menu		Edit menu	
Open	⌘-O	Undo	⌘-Z
Close	⌘-W, ⌘-K	Cut	⌘-X
New Document	⌘-N	Copy	⌘-C
Save	⌘-S	Paste	⌘-V
Print	⌘-P	Select All	⌘-A
Quit	⌘-Q	Clear	Delete

Additionally, virtually all Desktop programs support ⌘-Period and/or Escape to cancel or stop an operation in progress.

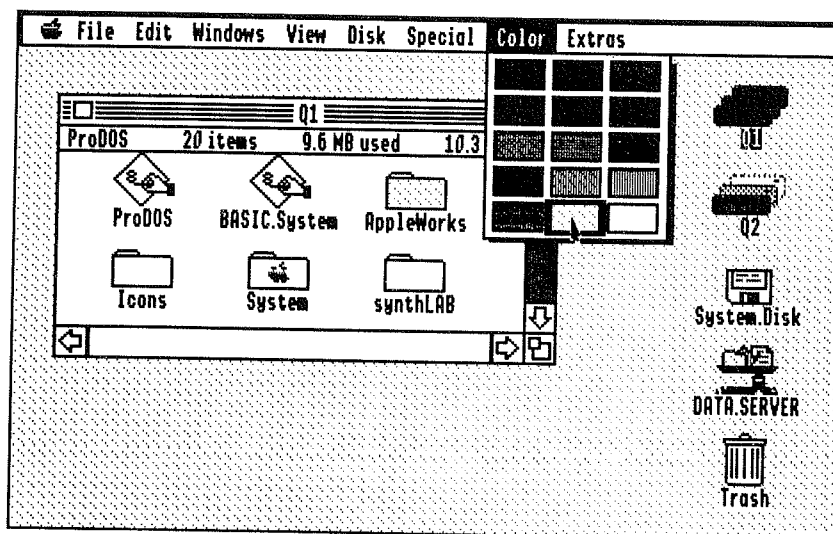


Figure 5D—Custom Menus (Color Menu, from Finder)